

YOUSSEF ELSAYYAD

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SUMMARY

Software Engineering student at McMaster University with 4+ years of independent security research on HackerOne. Specializes in web application vulnerability discovery and validation using Python tooling, Burp Suite, and GitHub Actions CI/CD. Disclosed over 100 security flaws across major platforms and government programs, demonstrating strong analytical, troubleshooting, and incident response fundamentals.

EDUCATION

McMaster University

Bachelor of Engineering, Software Engineering

Sep 2024 - Jun 2028

Hamilton, ON

• **GPA:** 3.6

• **Coursework:** COMPSCI 3IS3: Information Security, SFWRENG 3SH3: Operating Systems, SFWRENG 2AA4: Software Design I - Introduction to Software Development

EXPERIENCE

HackerOne

Sep 2021 - Present

Independent Security Researcher

Remote

- Disclosed 100+ security vulnerabilities with documented CVEs and CVSS scores across major web platforms and government bug bounty programs, earning over \$30,000 USD in bounties from companies including the US Department of Defense, Vimeo, Dailymotion, and Roblox / Guilded.
- Span IDOR, stored XSS, SQL injection, RCE, source code disclosure, privilege escalation, authentication bypass, and business-logic flaws, mapping each to OWASP Top 10 and CWE classifications and aligning them with NIST framework controls, which enabled prioritized remediation and reduced overall risk exposure
- Built Python tooling for proof-of-concept generation and exploit validation, giving vendor security teams reproducible artifacts instead of screenshots and integrating incident response playbook steps to accelerate containment and escalation.
- Reverse-engineered JavaScript bundles using Chrome DevTools and static analysis to map authentication flows and hidden API surfaces; this uncovered undocumented endpoints that were subsequently patched by vendors, strengthening the applications' access controls
- Authored technical reports translating risk for engineering teams and non-security stakeholders, aligning findings with ISO 27001 requirements, CIA triad principles, and NIST framework guidelines; collaborated with vendor security teams through coordinated disclosure and fix validation.

PROJECTS

Security Research Blog elsayyay.github.io/bounty-blog

2026 - Present

- Publish technical writeups on coordinated disclosures for identified CVEs, detailing reproduction steps, CVSS scoring, root cause analysis, and remediation guidance aligned with CIA triad principles
- Maintain an automated build-and-deploy pipeline through GitHub Actions, integrating linting, link validation, and OWASP Top 10 security checks into the workflow

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming Languages:** Python, Bash, Java, SQL, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MariaDB, C#
- **Security & Networking Tools:** Burp Suite, Nmap, Metasploit, OWASP Top 10, JavaScript bundle analysis, HTTP/REST/GraphQL, session management, coordinated disclosure, Networks
- **Security Frameworks & Practices:** CIA Triad, CVE, CVSS Scores, ISO 27001, NIST Framework, Incident Response
- **Development & DevOps:** Git, GitHub, GitHub Actions, Linux, Kali, Debian, Agile workflows, AI-assisted development tools

CERTIFICATIONS

- CompTIA Security+: July 2026
- Android App Hacking – Black Belt Edition: (Udemy, 54 hours) – Dec 2025 – Feb 2026